



The Central Government has also approved railway expansions in the Malwa region, enhancing regional connectivity and employment.

Modern-Day Matrushakti: Empowering India's Daughters PM Modi spotlighted the massive strides taken toward economic and social empowerment of women:

30 crore Jan Dhan accounts for women

10 crore women active in Self-Help Groups

1.5 crore "Lakhpati Didis" created, with a target of 3 crore

Women leading 45% of Indian startups

Over 100 women scientists part of the Chandrayaan-3 mission

Historic legislation: Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, reserving seats for women in Parliament and State Assemblies From banking to space, village leadership to national defense, India's daughters are leading from the front.

National Security and Women's Valor: Operation Sindoor

The Prime Minister also referenced Operation Sindoor, launched in response to a terrorist attack in Pahalgam. Describing it as an attack on India's culture and women, he said India responded with strength.

The BSF's women personnel played a critical role in this mission. Women are now admitted to Sainik Schools, with participation in the NCC doubled to 50%. The first batch of women cadets has graduated from the National Defence Academy (NDA). Today, women fly fighter jets, command naval ships, and even sail around the globe in oceanic missions.

A Vision for an Empowered India

In conclusion, Prime Minister Modi invoked Maa Bharati and Matrishakti, saluting the thousands of women present. "The sindoor that symbolizes devotion and dignity," he said, "now also represents India's courage and resolve."

He reaffirmed that the legacy of Lokmata Devi Ahilyabai Holkar will continue to inspire inclusive development, cultural preservation, and women-led progress across India.



strategies, ensuring progress for farmers, youth, women, and the underprivileged.

Lokmata Devi Ahilyabai Holkar: A Timeless Beacon of Governance and Grace

Born 300 years ago, Ahilyabai Holkar stands out as a visionary ruler who redefined leadership during a time of foreign dominance. Carrying her Shivalinga across her journey, she combined spiritual strength with administrative brilliance, leading her kingdom with compassion, discipline, and a firm commitment to justice.

She restored temples, most notably Kashi Vishwanath, promoted crop diversification, and pioneered textile development by inviting weavers from Gujarat to Maheshwar—laying the foundation of the globally renowned Maheshwari saree industry.

Ahilyabai also fought social evils, opposed child marriage, and formed women-led village security groups, setting an example centuries ahead of her time. Her legacy, as PM Modi noted, disproves the false narratives often cast by Western critics about women in Indian society.

Women-Led Development: A Central Pillar of Governance

Prime Minister Modi underlined how the current administration is honoring this legacy through women-centric welfare policies. Over 40 million homes have been built for the poor—most in women's names—empowering them as property owners and decision-makers.

Programs such as the Ujjwala Yojana have delivered clean cooking fuel to millions, improving health and saving time for women. Electricity and piped drinking water have made daily life easier and enabled girls to stay in school.

"Women are the soul of our development journey," PM Modi said. "We are not just working for women, we are working with women."

Celebrating Contemporary Women

Changemakers

The event was also a platform to honour today's torchbearers of women's empowerment. The Prime Minister was welcomed by four remarkable women: Ms. Gyaneshwari Devi (Jabalpur) – Serving cancer patients selflessly.

Ms. Prachi Yadav – India's first female canoeist and Arjuna Awardee.

Smt. Aarti Patel – A Sarpanch from Dhar district known for rural sanitation and development.

Ms. Meenakshi Thakle – Leader of a Maheshwar-based Self-Help Group engaged in traditional saree weaving.

PM Modi presented the Devi Ahilyabai National Award to Dr. Jayamati Kashyap, a tribal artist from Chhattisgarh. He also released a ₹300 commemorative coin and a postal stamp to mark the occasion.

Exhibition and Dialogue: Reflecting on Legacy, Shaping the Future

Earlier, the Prime Minister visited a dedicated exhibition showcasing Ahilyabai's life, contributions to governance, women's self-reliance, and temple restoration. He interacted with women artisans, handloom workers, and drone operators under the Drone Didi scheme, reviewing state initiatives that empower women in rural housing, agriculture, tourism, and local governance.

Accelerating Development in Madhya Pradesh

The occasion was also marked by the launch of major infrastructure projects:

Datia and Satna airports

The Indore Metro

₹483 crore for 1,271 new Panchayat Bhavans (Atal Gram Seva Sadans)

Improved air connectivity will boost religious tourism to revered sites like Maa Pitambari in Datia and Maa Sharda in Satna. Indore, already India's cleanest city, enters a new era with its metro services.